

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 6 4 3

♥ A 5 3

♦ 10 7 5

♣ 9 3

♠ A Q 5

♥ 7 4

♦ Q 9 6 2

♣ A J 10 8



♠ K 10

♥ Q J 10 9 8 2

♦ 8 3

♣ 6 5 2

♠ 8 7 2

♥ K 6

♦ A K J 4

♣ K Q 7 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

QUEEN OF SPADES AND NOBODY WILL GET HURT.

What if you tried the finesse and East had the ♠K? And what if he then switched to the ♥Q? And what if your opponents then took the next 6 ♥ tricks?

I think you get the idea. Win the ♠A immediately and then take your other 8 tricks.

There are times when you have to take finesses - like when you just have to find one more winner.

This wasn't one of those times.

With 16 points and a balanced hand you should open 1NT. Do not worry about the lack of a ♠ stopper, a 1NT opening does not guarantee stoppers in all four suits.

Partner raises you to 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠4.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠4.

Winners: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 4 : Total = 9

It's nice to have a hand where the Winner count is 9. And guess what? West probably has the ♠K, so you can finesse on the first trick for an overtrick.

HOLD IT! JUST STEP AWAY FROM THE

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 4
♥ J 9 5
♦ K 10 7 5
♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ K Q J
♥ A 8 6 2
♦ Q 6 3
♣ 10 9 4



♠ 7 2
♥ Q 10 4 3
♦ A J 9 2
♣ Q 7 3

♠ 10 9 8 6 5 3
♥ K 7
♦ 8 4
♣ A K J

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Don't think of passing. With 11 HCP and 2 length points you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♥. What is your next bid?

You must bid and you want to show that you have a bare minimum. You don't want to say 2NT because of that doubleton nothing ♦. So you rebid your 6-card ♠ suit. Partner bids 4 ♠ and everybody passes.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♦ 5 on which you play dummy's ♦ 3. East wins ♦ J, plays ♦ A, then ♦ 2.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♦ 5 on which you play dummy's ♦ 3. East wins ♦ J, plays ♦ A, then ♦ 2.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You have already lost the 2 ♦ s and you sure can't escape losing the Ace of trumps. So you mustnot lose a ♣ trick. So your Plan will be to pull trumps, then finesse East for the ♣ Q.

You ruff the third ♦, play ♠ s until the ♠ A appears. When you regain the lead you pull any outstanding trumps, play one high ♣, (in case someone has a singleton ♣ Q), then enter dummy with the ♥ A and make the ♣ finesse. Half of the time you make the contract, the other half you don't.

You were lucky that the ♣ Q was with East.

It's never great when the success of your contract depends on a finesse, but sometimes that's your only hope - a 50% chance.